VIDACRUZ AI

FREE KIT · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Daily Brief Lite

Every morning at 8:00, Slack shows your portfolio value, today's move, your best and worst holding, your progress to your FIRE number and the headlines that matter. You build it once, in about 30 minutes, on free plans.

Time to set up	Cost	Make credits	Coding
≈ 30 min	AED 0	≈ 6 a day	None

⏰ 8:00 → Google Sheets → Text aggregator → RSS news → Text aggregator → Gemini → Slack

The sheet does all the maths with Google's free price formulas. Gemini only writes the words, using the numbers it is given.

What you need

Google account FREE	For Google Sheets. Any Gmail account works.
Slack FREE	A workspace you own. Create one at `slack.com/get-started` if you don't have one.
Make.com FREE	The free plan gives 1,000 credits a month and 2 active scenarios. This brief uses about 180 a month.

Gemini API key FREE	From Google AI Studio. The free tier is enough. Google may use free-tier prompts to improve its products; this brief only sends prices and headlines. If you'd rather it didn't, turn on billing for the key (it costs cents a month).

Part 1 · Your portfolio sheet

1. Open the template: **Make a copy of the Daily Brief Lite sheet**. Google asks to make a copy; click **Make a copy**. It lands in your Drive as *Copy of Daily Brief Lite – My Portfolio (template)*. Rename it **My Portfolio**.
2. Replace the five example rows (rows 2–6) with your holdings. Fill only the four white columns: **Ticker**, **Name**, **Quantity**, **Avg cost**. Everything else calculates by itself. There is room for 10 holdings; to add more, insert rows above row 11 and copy row 10's formulas down.
3. In **J14**, type your FIRE number from the VidaCruz calculator (for example `4500000`).
4. Check column **K (Brief line)**: every holding should read like `NASDAQ:AAPL (Apple) | price 347.73 USD | today -0.1% | …`. If a line says *no price found*, fix the ticker.

YOU HOLD	TYPE THE TICKER LIKE THIS
US stocks	`NASDAQ:AAPL`, `NYSE:JPM`
US ETFs	`NYSEARCA:VOO`, `NASDAQ:QQQ`
India	`NSE:INFY`, `NSE:RELIANCE`
London	`LON:HSBA` (prices in pence)
Crypto	`CURRENCY:BTCUSD`, `CURRENCY:ETHUSD` (no daily % change)
UAE (DFM / ADX)	Google's formula doesn't cover most UAE shares. Type the price into the **Price** cell yourself and set **Currency** to `AED`. The paid Daily Brief Pro reads UAE prices for you.

Not sure of a ticker? Search the company on `google.com/finance`: the code shown under its name (like `NASDAQ: NVDA`) is what goes in the sheet, without the space.

Part 2 · Slack channel

1. In your Slack workspace, click **+** next to Channels › **Create a channel**.
2. Name it **daily-brief**, keep it **Public** (it's still only visible inside your workspace) and create it.

Part 3 · Gemini API key

1. Go to `aistudio.google.com` and sign in with your Google account.
2. Click **Get API key** › **Create API key**. Pick or create a project if asked.
3. Copy the key (it starts with `AIza`). Keep it private: don't paste it into chats or emails.

Part 4 · Make.com account

1. Sign up at `make.com` (free plan, no card needed).
2. Set your time zone, or the brief arrives at the wrong hour: click your avatar (bottom left) › **Profile** › **Time zone** › **Asia/Dubai** (or yours) › **Save changes**.
3. Go to **Scenarios** › **Create a new scenario**.

Shortcut: instead of adding each node by hand, download daily-brief-lite.blueprint.json (right-click › Save link as, if it opens as text), then in the empty scenario click ⋯ (bottom toolbar) › **Import Blueprint** › choose the file › **Save**. All six nodes appear with their settings. You still need to do the parts marked **You choose** below: your connections, your sheet and your channel.

Part 5 · The scenario, node by node

Add each node with the big **+** (or the small + to the right of the last node), search for the app, pick the action, then fill the fields exactly as shown. Text in `{{ }}` is a value from an earlier node: click into the field and pick it from the panel that opens (the number is the node's number in your scenario).

1 Google Sheets › Get Range Values

Reads the ready-made brief lines from your sheet

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Connection	**You choose:** click **Create a connection** › **Sign in with Google** › allow access.
Search Method	Enter manually
Spreadsheet ID	**You choose:** the long code in your sheet's web address, between `/d/` and `/edit`. Example: `docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1AbC…xYz/edit`
Sheet Name	Portfolio
Range	`K2:K14`
Table contains headers	No

It returns one bundle per row: your holdings, the total and your FIRE progress.

2 Tools › Text aggregator

Joins those rows into one block of text

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Source Module	Google Sheets – Get Range Values [1]
Row separator	New row
Text	Click the field, then in the panel under *Google Sheets – Get Range Values* click the first item: the brief line from column K. It shows as `1. 0` (behind the scenes `{{1.`0`}}`).

Add a filter on the link between node 1 and node 2 (click the dotted line › **Set up a filter**): Label *Only filled rows*, Condition: that same item from node 1, operator **Basic operators › Exists**. Empty rows are skipped.

3 RSS › Retrieve RSS Feed Items

Brings in the latest market headlines

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
URL	`https://news.google.com/rss/search?q=stock+market+OR+oil+OR+bitcoin+when:1d&hl=en-AE&gl=AE&ceid=AE:en`
Maximum number of returned items	8

Make it yours: replace `stock+market+OR+oil+OR+bitcoin` with words that match your holdings, joined by `+OR+`, for example `nvidia+OR+apple+OR+sensex`.

4 Tools › Text aggregator

Joins the headlines into one list

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Source Module	RSS – Retrieve RSS Feed Items [3]
Row separator	New row
Text	`- {{3.title}}`

5 Google Gemini AI › Generate a response

Writes your brief from the numbers and headlines

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Connection	**You choose: Create a connection** › paste your Gemini API key › **Save**.
AI Model	Gemini Flash Latest `gemini-flash-latest` (it moves to Google's newest Flash model by itself, so it never gets retired)
Messages › Add item	Role: **User** · Parts › Add item › Message Type: **Text** · Text: the prompt below

```
You are my morning market assistant. Today is {{formatDate(now; "dddd D
MMMM YYYY"; "Asia/Dubai")}}.

Write my Daily Brief for Slack using ONLY the facts below. Never invent
numbers, prices or news, and never calculate new numbers.

Format (Slack formatting: *bold* with single asterisks, bullets with •,
no tables, under 150 words):
☀️ *Good morning. Portfolio AED [value]* and today's change in AED,
from the PORTFOLIO TOTAL line.
• Best and worst holding today, with their move.
• My FIRE progress line, if there is one.
📰 *Markets*: 2 or 3 bullets from the headlines that matter most for my
holdings. If none matter, say "No big news for your holdings."
Last line, in italics: Not financial advice.

MY PORTFOLIO:
{{2.text}}

TODAY'S HEADLINES:
{{4.text}}
```

In the Text field, the two `{{…}}` lines at the bottom must be the green **Text** values from node 2 and node 4: delete the typed version and pick them from the panel. `formatDate` and `now` can stay as typed.

6 Slack › Create a Message

Posts the brief to #daily-brief

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Connection	**You choose: Create a connection** › sign in to your workspace › **Allow**.
Enter a channel ID or name	Enter manually
Channel ID or name	`#daily-brief`
Text	From node 5, open **Candidates › Content › Parts** and click **Text**. It reads `{{5.candidates[1].content.parts[1].text}}`.

Part 6 · Test it, then schedule it

This is the message our reference build posted when we tested this guide on 24 October 2026, using the example holdings in the template:

```
☀️ *Good morning. Portfolio AED 52,922* (today AED -155)
• Best holding: NSE:INFY (+0.0%), Worst holding: NASDAQ:NVDA (-0.6%)
• FIRE progress: 1.2% of your FIRE number AED 4,500,000

📰 *Markets*:
• AI pixie dust is losing its stock market power - Axios
• New York stock market closes week lower - Anadolu Ajansı

_Not financial advice._
```

1. Click **Save** (the disk icon), then **Run once**. Each node shows a bubble with a number when it worked.
2. Check Slack: the brief should be in **#daily-brief** within a few seconds.
3. Click the clock on the first node › **Run scenario: Every day** › **Time: 08:00** › **OK**.
4. Switch the scenario **ON** with the toggle at the bottom, and **Save** again.

That's it. From tomorrow, your brief arrives at 8:00 every day. It uses about 6 credits a run, so roughly 180 of your 1,000 free credits a month.

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Node 1 shows an error about the sheet	Pick the spreadsheet again from the list, and check the Sheet Name matches the tab at the bottom of your sheet.
The brief says a price is missing	Column K shows *no price found* for that ticker: fix the ticker format (see Part 1).
Node 5 says the API key isn't valid	Open node 5 › Connection › Edit, paste the key again with no spaces. Create a new key in AI Studio if needed.
Node 5 says quota exceeded	The free Gemini tier has a daily limit. Wait until tomorrow, or turn on billing for the key in AI Studio.
Node 6 can't find the channel	Make sure the channel is public, or invite the Make app to it by typing `/invite @Make` in the channel.
It arrives at the wrong time	Set your time zone in your Make profile (Part 4, step 2).
No headlines	Open the RSS URL in your browser: if it shows nothing, change the search words.

Where to go next

Daily Brief Lite is the first kit in the VidaCruz AI Team. When you're ready for more, the paid kits add UAE prices, stop-loss and target alerts, FX alerts for sending money home, a job scout, a LinkedIn ghostwriter and a CEO you can ask anything in Slack. Each comes with the same node-by-node guide. See them on the VidaCruz AI Team page.

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